

Brainsquare

The Chronicles
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montova



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Foreword by Mark Van Hamme

Cherishing the connection with our colleagues



One of my personal highlights of these past months has been my visit to our colleagues in India. On February 10th, I attended their 'Premier League', a yearly event to foster health and camaraderie among colleagues through various sports competitions.

I was truly impressed by the organization, the enthusiasm of the people, and the joyful competitive atmosphere. It was a reminder of how important building community and communication is for us. It's one of our core values: We believe in real human contact as a basis for positive outcomes.

Speaking of which: In the past months, we've strengthened our Belgian teams, both in depth and in breath. We've taken people on board who will help with the organization but also technical people with tons of expertise. And we got traction with our internship program, meant to attract the best and motivated students to do an internship at Brainsquare and – if there is a mutual match – to join our workforce as junior developers.

While I'm brainstorming about this introduction, I've just landed from visiting our colleagues in Dallas, USA. They are a dedicated team, essential for the way we work, essential also as interface with our USA customers. But they are a small team, so I'd like to take the opportunity and ask you to reach out and bond with them whenever you get the chance. A shoutout to Jason, Edward and Sai!

Enjoy this newsletter!

Mark Van Hamme

New Year's Party 2024

In January, Brainsquare and Montova gathered for a New Year's Party in Leuven. The venue, De Hoorn, is modern with a touch of vintage warmth, since it holds historical significance as the place where the Belgian beer brand, Stella Artois, was produced in the 18th century. Since, it has been transformed into a bustling business and digital hub.

The New Year's Party was a wonderful chance to reconnect with some of our partners and colleagues since the last gathering in Paris. The evening proceeded with conversations, drinks, food, and dancing. We received positive feedback on the food, and we hope it catered to everyone's tastes. The beer, in particular, was exceptionally fresh!

Here are some pictures taken at the party; you can find more on [Brainsquare](#) and [Montova's](#) LinkedIn accounts or the office Local drive – Common (:z). As we look ahead, we welcome any suggestions or ideas for next year's party. Don't hesitate to reach out to the coaches or the Office Management team. We look forward to hearing your thoughts and making the next celebration even more memorable!



New Year's Party 2024

More pictures!



Updates from India: Doyen Premier League 2024

Each year, our Indian colleagues and offices organize the 'Doyen Premier League', an event designed to foster camaraderie among colleagues through sports. That camaraderie embodies the mutual trust and friendship among individuals who spend a lot of time together. Cultivating such bonds is integral to our corporate mission. The event also encourages employee well-being, offering stress relief, enhancing mental agility, and promoting physical fitness.

Doyen Premier League 2024 featured a range of activities including Zumba, Hock Ball, Hitt D Ball, Live LUDO, Military Race, and Cricket matches. Cricket is the most popular sport in India and holds significant importance in India's culture. Participants enthusiastically embraced the spirit of playfulness and teamwork throughout the event, exemplifying their commitment to unity.

If you are curious to see more about Doyen Premier League 2024, check their video here:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=TiXnR4lwAEo>



Customers

Montova Field Trip: Katoen Natie Operation Site

In January, Montova had the opportunity to visit Katoen Natie's operational sites in Antwerp, Belgium. This visit gave us valuable insights into our customers' work processes and allowed us to hear about their experiences firsthand. During the tour, we gained a comprehensive understanding of how the warehouse operates, including the functionality of the storage and picking system, among other key aspects. Katoen Natie handles a wide range of shipments worldwide, from large industrial equipment like steel and iron to everyday items.

Throughout the tour, Katoen Natie's commitment to safety, accuracy, and efficiency left an inspiring impression. We had the chance to observe various types of robots, including one that resembled vacuum robots like Roomba but was capable of transporting shelves loaded with numerous boxes to the correct position, and another robot that could custom-make boxes to fit each product perfectly. Additionally, we were introduced to their latest technological innovation, "AutoStore", which we discussed in our previous Chronicles article. The entire experience was quite impressive

If you're interested in learning more about how Montova's EDI is implemented at Katoen Natie, be sure to check out [this article](#)!



*Pictures are only for internal use, please don't use them publicly.

Customers

Brainsquare Atlassian team completes major Cloud migration

In December 2022, our Brainsquare Atlassian Team started working on a migration from Server (on-premises) to Cloud for one of our major customers: Atlas Copco Group.

Atlas Copco challenged us to split their single server instance into multiple Cloud sites, one for each division in the company. This required a thorough analysis to make sure all pieces of data would go to the correct Cloud sites. This was significantly more complex than just migrating the server to one Cloud site.

During the first three months of the project, we mainly focused on fixing some issues together with Atlassian, issues that were blocking us from bringing the first teams to Cloud. The pressure grew significantly with each month as some teams within Atlas Copco Group counted on the completion to offboard other applications to save money. Due to the complexity of the server instance, as well as Atlassian's ever-ongoing releases of new features on Cloud, it took until late March 2023 before all blockers were solved and we were ready to perform the first tests.

Early April 2023, one of the first full successful test migrations took place. This first migration included a significant amount of data and impacted approximately 600 users. Fun fact: this first successful test migration was performed on an airplane. Yes, an actual airplane while flying to Chicago, USA. Although the network connection wasn't great, we wanted to continue working as our deadlines became tighter. After many network disconnections and page refreshes, we were able to start the Cloud Migration Assistant, the tool helping us to migrate data.

Shortly after, on April 29th 2023, the first production migration took place. The first piece of Jira and Confluence was successfully migrated to the Cloud at that point. From this moment on, our team started working on multiple migrations in parallel. Due to the scale of the project, we welcomed two of our colleagues from the Mumbai office at our HQ in Zaventem. They stayed for a little more than 2 months to closely align during the peak of the migration journey. In total, 20 separate production migrations took place over the course of 2023, with the last one finishing on March 18th, 2024.

Migrations are hard work, especially as our team needed to recreate a lot of configurations during the migration weekends. Some weekends were extra hard, requiring us to work on Friday evening, Saturday and even Sunday.

For that, we also want to express our sincerest gratitude to our colleagues Yogesh Mude, Steyn Roefs, Abhipsa Mohaptra, Dominiek Van Laenen, Sakshi Jain, Jochim Van Dijck, Siddesh Gharatkar and our former colleague Amit Singh. Their contributions to the project were greatly appreciated. We couldn't have finished it without all of you and your dedication. I'm extremely proud to have such a strong team. Thank you!

Jorden Van Bogaert
Atlassian Service Delivery Manager

Take a breath of fresh air at Brainsquare



Do you sometimes have difficulties focusing in the afternoon? Would you like to take a moment to escape from all those meetings?

Why not join us for a 15-minute walk during lunch? Taking a break from your daily routines and getting a breath of fresh air can be truly invigorating.

Walking in the outside air helps reduce stress, enhances your concentration and creativity, and, most importantly, contributes to your physical health by providing a natural intake of vitamin D. Additionally, getting to know your colleagues outside the office walls will improve your work atmosphere.

We usually leave around 12:10. Feel free to gather at the Brainsquare reception and join us for a walk!

Ingrid Jacobs & Michel Berix

Inside Boardgame Night



You probably remember receiving an invitation to “Boardgame Night”. We host this event quarterly, a fun and relaxing evening with colleagues at the office, enjoying games, drinks, and food. For those who hesitate to join or are curious about participating for the first time, we've prepared this article to give you some insight.

What is it like to join Boardgame Night?

Participants gather to relax, play games, eat, chat, and drink. You can bring games you want to play, or the foods and drinks you would like to enjoy. Drinks in the office are, of course, free. Participants are a mix of experienced boardgame players and people who are new to the experience.

Let's hear what some of the participants have to say!

Michel Berix “Playing board games is a guarantee for a fun time with friends. Boardgame Night at B² allows you to get to know your colleagues in another way and have fun together. Additionally, you will learn new games that your colleagues bring to the evening. I for one am proud of my own collection and want to teach colleagues games that I enjoyed before. Moreover, you will develop your creativity by creating a strategy responding to that of your opponents. Some games even have themes that make you learn something about history or culture.”

Daeun Jung “Although I am not a regular boardgame player, and lack expertise in gaming, I've found that the selection of games at Boardgame Night is accessible and enjoyable for all skill levels. I genuinely enjoy playing the games at the event, and it is a great opportunity for me to learn and improve my boardgame knowledge and skills.”

We also asked Chris Peeraer, the host of the event, a few questions:

What kind of games do I get to play during the event?

Chris Games vary each time, and we have a wide selection. We typically divide into groups based on individuals' preferences, such as those who enjoy longer, more serious games, and those who prefer quicker, lighter ones.

Could you give us a few recommendations that have been played during Boardgame Night?

Chris There are loads more, but I would say...

Ticket to Ride

a typical “gateway game” (not heavy at all and way more fun than Monopoly)



Inside Boardgame Night



Power Grid

a classic albeit somewhat heavier game



Pandemic

a cooperative boardgame, where you work as a team to defeat the game



Pictures from previous events



Hope to see you in the next game event!
If you have any questions: feel free to contact chris.peeraer@brain2.com

Promote reading company email



Dear Brainsquare and Montova colleague,

Allow us a moment to promote our internal email platform, your @Brain2.com or @Montova.com email addresses. Maybe you work 100% for a client and don't use your company email. That may be the case, but sometimes important company information is sent to that address. It may not be wise to forward private information to an external address or customer email account. That is why we use our internal email addresses.

I know, you already have a lot of email addresses... your personal one, your customer account, your... and then you also need to check your @Brain2.com or @Montova.com.

But hey, the technology didn't stop. You probably have some kind of Outlook client on your laptop or even on your phone. You can easily add an extra account to that.

This way you can see the internal emails coming in without much effort. Think about it, one small step to add the account and you will never miss important information about holidays, events, newsletters, parties...



**Congratulations to our colleague for obtaining
his new certificate!**



Dheeraj Ayati
Kubernetes Administrator (CKA)



Welcome to our new colleagues!



January 23rd, 2024
Manisha Bhosale - .NET Software Engineer - B² India



March 1st, 2024
Jeroen Pelsmaekers - Senior .Net Software Engineer - B² Belgium



March 4th, 2024
Sven Collin - CFO - Brainsquare-Group



March 18th, 2024
Niels Palinckx - Software Solution Architect - B² Belgium



April 2nd, 2024
Stijn Lekens - Sales Manager - B² HQ



April 2nd, 2024
Lijo John - .NET Software Engineer - B² India



April 15th, 2024
Thomas Van Hoezen - Operations Director - Montova HQ



Subcontractors

December 27th, 2023

Raf Withofs - Frontend Development - Belgian Brewers

February 2nd, 2024

Guy Van Put - Agile Coaching - Atlas Copco (GEMS project)

February 12th, 2024

Stefaan Van Goolen - Integration Project Manager - Atlas Copco (EAI Team)

Internship

March 11th, 2024 - May 31st, 2024

Michael Fernandez-Juarez - Software Engineer - B² HQ



Feel free to send any ideas for new topics, suggestions or comments to [Nathalie](#)